

VOYAGER PILOTS

Jeana Yeager and Dick Rutan attend to Voyager, the aircraft that they flew nonstop around the world without refueling in December 1986. They traveled at only 110mph (175kph), the speed that would give the maximum distance for every gallon of fuel. Although they alternated at the controls, in principle allowing enough rest, fatigue became a serious problem during the nine-day journey.

**VOYAGER IN FLIGHT**

Like the Wright brothers, Voyager designer Burt Rutan favored canard designs, with stabilizers at the front instead of on the tail. In the Voyager, these canard surfaces were extended to link twin side fuselages that were in effect long fuel tanks. Between them was the central fuselage with a cockpit and a tiny cabin, and two engines front and back driving pusher and tractor propellers.